Hi Mallory!

It's Taco Tuesday, and the exciting news is here :)))

Poolboy Taco, Aspen's award-winning "festival taco," is finally getting a pernament home in Arcadia this December.

From the Gadzooks team, Poolboy is brining a poolside-inspired, elevated quick-service concept into a unique, design-forward retro space, complete with frozen cocktails, carrot cake and a menu built around the taco that started it all.

This one is going to be soo fun, and I especially can't wait to hit up the salsa bar!

Let me know if you'd be interested in speaking with Aaron Pool, and if I can provide any additional details.

Loyally,

Angela

Angela Anderson <angela@mmprmarketing.com> wrote:

POOLBOY TACO

Poolboy Taco to Debut First Brick-and-Mortar in Arcadia

Festival-favorite pop-up transforms former Gadzooks into a bold, design-forward fast-casual restaurant



Additional Photos (Credit: Poolhouse Group)

PHOENIX – Poolhouse Group, the family behind Gadzooks Enchiladas & Soup and The Green Woodpecker, is bringing its next big idea to life with the debut of Poolboy Taco. Known for long lines at Aspen Food & Wine and buzzy pop-ups in Hollywood, Poolboy will finally have a home of its own this December in Phoenix's Arcadia neighborhood, taking over the former Gadzooks space at 40th Street & Camelback Road (4031 E. Camelback Road).

The new restaurant reimagines the 1950's-era quick-service experience with a cheeky, design-forward vibe that blends festival energy with midcentury, poolside nostalgia. With interiors conceived in collaboration with local design firm House of Form, Poolboy is best described as a refined, escapist taco lounge where indulgence meets irony, where Slim Aarons meets Palm Springs.

The result is an environment that Poolboy has coined as 'Quality Quick Service,' with deliberately over-the-top yet tasteful energy: pastel neons, terrazzo flooring, brass accents, and sculptural banquettes that channel both retro diners and poolside cabanas. Guests will enter beneath striped awnings into a dining room filled with cushy red vinyl banquettes, terrazzo tables, playful murals, and a PHX heart wall installation. A golden seal sculpture serves as a tongue-in-cheek mascot, while outside, a cabana-style patio lined with hedges and striped seating creates a breezy extension of the dining room.

At just over **2,100 square feet**, the space will seat around **45 to 55 guests**, split between the interior lounge and dining areas and the outdoor patio. The kitchen has been enclosed in glass, giving diners a glimpse of the action. Ordering takes place at a bold new counter, accented with brass rails, striped fronts, and a retro "ORDER HERE" marquee. Drinks, including frozen cocktails, margaritas, and draft beer, are picked up at the counter and enjoyed in branded **32-ounce Poolboy cups**, designed as collectibles.

The menu builds from the taco that started it all: the **Poolboy Taco**, also known as the "festival taco," which has won multiple awards and built the brand's cult following. Offered in both soft and crunchy versions, the Poolboy Taco will be joined by options including a beef taco, a breakfast taco, nachos, a composed enchilada, a salad, and even a bowl option. To keep things fresh, Poolboy will also feature a **Taco of the Month** program, designed to showcase collaborations with other local chefs, and limited-time creations. A salsa bar, featuring five house salsas ranging from pico de gallo to habanero, reinforces Poolboy's laid-back approach while offering guests freedom to explore and experiment.For dessert, the restaurant will rotate cake varieties including carrot and German chocolate, alongside seasonal specialties that build on the Pool family's tradition of craveable sweets.

For Pool, Poolboy fills a gap in the Arcadia dining landscape. "People here want a place that's fun, social, and not overly expensive, but still feels special," he says. "Poolboy is built to be that third space and a spot where you can grab a margarita, hang out on the patio, and feel like you're somewhere completely different."

Construction on Poolboy is scheduled to begin immediately, with the Arcadia Gadzooks last day of service being Saturday, November 8. Gadzooks staff will all remain with the company and shift to other locations.

Poolboy Taco will open this December at **4031 E. Camelback Road in Phoenix**. Guests can follow **@poolboytaco** on Instagram or visit www.poolboytaco.com for updates and opening announcements.

About Poolboy Taco

Born from a chalkboard brainstorming session in 2014, the Poolboy Taco was created by brothers Aaron & Jared Pool, and gained underground momentum by winning Best in Show consecutive years at the Arizona Taco Festival, popping up at charity and social events, and eventually on center stage at Aspen Food & Wine, where it captured national attention in 2022. Since then, Poolboy has become a brand synonymous with high energy, fun vibes and outlandishly flavorful tacos: a mix of camp and craft that feels right at home in Phoenix.

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FOOD & RESTAURANT NEWS GRAND OPENING

Poolboy Taco Makes Its Debut in Arcadia This May

BY **MALLORY GLEICH** · MAY 11, 2026 · 2 MINUTE READ

Phoenix's dining scene is about to get a colorful new addition as Poolboy Taco officially opens its first brick-and-mortar location on May 18. Created by Poolhouse Group, the team behind Gadzooks and The Green Woodpecker, the concept will take over the former Gadzooks space at 40th and Camelback Road.

For years, Poolboy built a cult following through appearances at the Aspen Food & Wine Festival and pop-ups in Hollywood. Now, the concept finally has a permanent home, bringing its playful personality and over-the-top aesthetic to Phoenix.



Images courtesy of Poolboy Tacos

The restaurant centers on midcentury poolside nostalgia, pairing retro diner inspiration with a lively atmosphere. Designed in collaboration with House of Form, the 2,100-square-foot space features terrazzo flooring, brass accents, pastel neon lighting, striped awnings, cushy vinyl banquettes, and murals throughout the dining room. A cabana-style patio, lined with hedges and striped seating, extends the experience outdoors, while a glass-enclosed kitchen gives guests a glimpse of the action behind the counter.

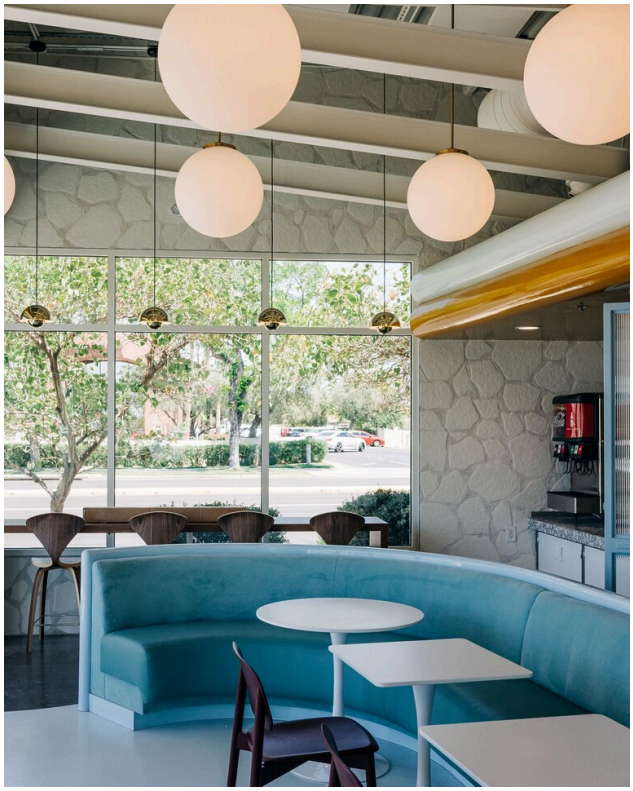
The team describes the concept as "Quality Quick Service," blending elevated design details with a relaxed atmosphere. Drinks, including frozen cocktails, margaritas, and draft beer, are served in collectible 22-ounce Poolboy cups.



At the center of the menu are personality-driven tacos served on Poolboy's signature "50/50" tortilla, a proprietary blend of corn and flour, or a crispy yellow corn shell. The Poolboy Taco leads the lineup with tomatillo chicken, sweet-and-spicy cornbread, jalapeño ranch, honey glaze, and cotija.

Additional taco offerings range from breakfast-inspired combinations to more indulgent creations. The Ric features pinto beans, onion, and jack cheese, while the Ron swaps in spicy black beans and cheddar. Hearty options like the Duke combine bacon, smashed potato, egg, and cheddar, while the Aspen layers Wagyu ground beef with smashed potato, egg, and cheddar.





Guests looking for larger, upgraded tacos can “Make It Gold” with options like the Walt, featuring Wagyu beef, pinto beans, and queso, or the Molly, made with Angus short rib, habanero, guacamole, and cotija. Vegetarians can opt for the Palm Lane with portobello mushrooms and smashed potatoes.

The menu expands with dishes like Big Boy Enchiladas topped with Christmas sauce, pico, slaw, and cotija, Uncle Rico’s Nachos layered with queso and jalapeño ranch, and the Poolboy Bowl with rice, beans, chicken, cornbread, and fresh toppings.

Quesadillas, burritos, salsa bar add-ons, queso, guacamole, and cornbread are also available. Desserts come courtesy of “Mama Linda,” the Pool brothers’ mother, and include housemade carrot cake, pumpkin cookies, and chocolate chip ice cream sandwiches. For more: poolboytaco.com.

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